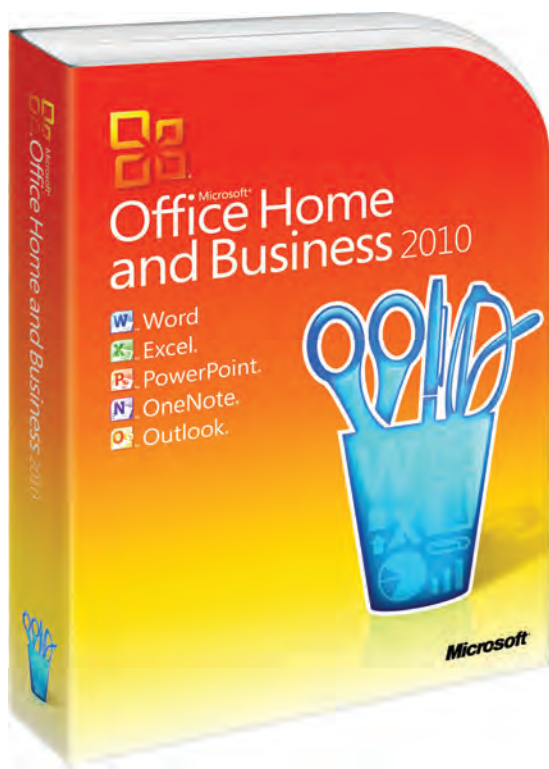


Save as DOCX

Saving in the .docx format is a good idea, as it offers better compression for the cloud and email over the traditional .doc format

2 Million

That's the number of times the beta version of Office 2010 got downloaded



Office 2010 has some great changes at first glance, but is it really worth the upgrade?

Office 2010 worth it?

SharePoint support, and integration with Windows Live. This along with Office web apps means users can now access their files anywhere provided there's an internet connection, save files directly to their SharePoint server or Windows live and collaborate and edit documents simultaneously with other users. Let us delve a little deeper into what new Office 2010 promises to offer and what it has succeeded in doing so.

Backstage View is a new feature that provides information of your common tasks such as saving, printing and sharing documents. One of the most useful aspects of this view is the revised print preview, which combines all the previous printing and layout options and puts them next to a sleek print preview of your file for convenient access. Third-party add-ins can add features to the Backstage view, so you can expect the next generation of PDF viewers, OCR software, and other applications to install their own automation and integration features inside Office applications.

One minor change that could prove to be the biggest productivity enhancers in Office 2010 is an improved copy-and-paste feature. When you paste anything, you can now paste-preview how it will look depending on your paste choice. This is like an improvement we didn't know we wanted, but realised it's cool to have it.

New photo-editing options are available in some Office applications, like sharpening or softening, changing the contrast and colour saturation, cropping, remove background option, and a variety of Photoshop-wannabe "artistic effects." There is an Insert Screenshot icon on the ribbon which is kind of like [Windows] + [S] in OneNote 2007. It lets you blissfully illustrate your documents with anything on your display.

Microsoft Word 2010

There's not much you can add to Word, but the new interface is simple, and packed with some new small features

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Sometime in 2010, Microsoft will release the next version of its flagship Office suite. It has taken Microsoft a long time to integrate its office suite with the web, and now that it is finally arriving, everyone's asking whether it will provide enough change to entice an upgrade, or will it just remain a routine update for those still stuck on Office 2003?

After a few days of testing the beta version of Office 2010, we're impressed by the solid effort Microsoft has put in to polish and expand upon the groundwork it laid with Office 2007, while continuing to add new features. The ribbon-interface has been refined and enhanced. Outlook now comes with a powerful feature that combines your email with social networking sites such as Facebook and LinkedIn.

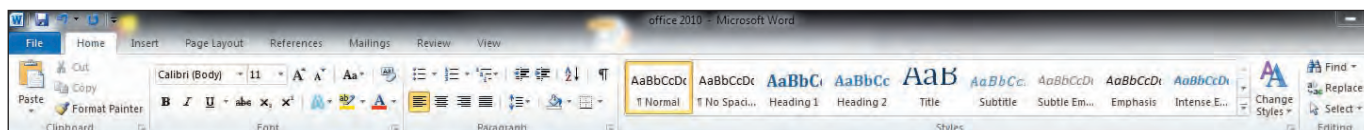
Microsoft has clearly focused a lot on network collaboration with improved

Overall improvement

Office will now also be available in a 64-bit version, although average users won't notice a significant difference.

Office 2010 bridges the gap between the Windows Vista and Windows 7 eras by streamlining the Ribbon user interface and extending it to encompass all the Office applications. The overall experience has also been tweaked by bringing its layout and structure in line with the Ribbon objects from the Windows 7 SDK. Users can now customise the ribbon without having to delve into XML to add their own tabs and commands.

The layout of the underlying button menu has been changed considerably. It is now a customised, window-spanning alternative view that combines information about the currently selected object with various actions and configuration options. And the view is also context sensitive, as in it adapts itself to match your current work status.



Word now has an improved and smoother ribbon with added features